

REFORM DEMOCRATS OF THE NEW COMMONWEALTH

Scoring Justification Record — Section C

Phase III Proposals (7 proposals) — Systemic Transformation (15-30 Years)

REF_RDNC_ScoringJustification_2026_SectionC — Framework v26 — Scoring Methodology v1.1 — Source Reference Guide v11 — Internal Reference — Not for Distribution

Score formula: **(GP + UT + B) / 1.5** — GP = Global Precedent (1-5) — UT = US Transition Difficulty (1-5: 5 = Minimal, 1 = Extreme) — B = Societal Benefit (1-5) — Source citations reference
REF_RDNC_SourceReferenceGuide_2026_11

[v26 revision] marks proposals where scores changed in Framework v26. Revision notes state what changed, why, and axis reassignment logic.

HEALTHCARE & SOCIAL PROGRAMS

P13 — Universal Government-Funded Healthcare

GP=5 · UT=1 · B=5 · Score: **7.3** · Phase III · Bill 9 — UCT Act (Phase III; Bill 6 must operate 4+ years first)

GP [5/5 — Proven]

Implemented at national scale in all 16 Tier 1 comparators; US spends \$14,885/capita (17.2% of GDP) vs. OECD average \$5,967 (9.3%); every peer nation provides universal coverage at lower cost; Commonwealth Fund: US ranks last on equity, access, and efficiency.

Sources: 39, 40, 41, 55, 192

UT [1/5 — Extremely Hard]

Structural barrier: ERISA §502 coordination, provider rate-setting, private insurance elimination (\$1.1T annual premiums), 60-vote Senate threshold, and organized industry opposition combine to make transition genuinely structural rather than merely political; German multi-payer model is most feasible path; 7+ year phased implementation minimum; CBO single-payer: +\$1.5–3.0T federal subsidies in 2030 alone.

Sources: 55, 56, 57, 58

B [5/5 — Critical]

Medical debt contributes to ~500,000 annual bankruptcies (Himmelstein et al., AJPH 2019); Sommers-Gawande-Baicker (NEJM 2012): Medicaid expansion reduced mortality 6.1%; universal coverage eliminates the coverage gaps, network inadequacy, and cost-sharing barriers that disproportionately burden lower-income Americans.

Sources: 39, 40, 41, 55

P14 — Bodily Autonomy Legal Framework

GP=4 · UT=2 · B=5 · Score: **7.3** · Phase III · Executive — Constitutional/judicial pathway

GP [4/5 — Strong]

France amended constitution to protect abortion rights (March 2024); Canada Morgentaler (1988) constitutional protection; Germany §218 StGB parliamentary protection; most of Western Europe provides statutory or constitutional protection; WHO documents restrictions increase unsafe abortion rates.

Sources: 49, 50, 51, 52

UT [2/5 — Very Hard]

Post-Dobbs constitutional landscape: federal statutory protection faces immediate challenge; interstate travel and commerce clause architecture requires doctrinal development; 60-vote Senate threshold; most durable protection requires constitutional amendment or significant Court composition change; UT=2 reflects statutory track feasibility under favorable conditions.

Sources: 49, 51, 53

B [5/5 — Critical]

ACOG documents abortion restrictions increase maternal mortality, complicate miscarriage and ectopic pregnancy care, and delay cancer treatment; IVF restrictions would eliminate ~75,000 births annually; Turnaway Study (Foster et al.): women denied abortions show worse economic, health, and child welfare outcomes across 5-year follow-up; gender-affirming care (Endocrine Society 2023) associated with significant mental health improvements.

Sources: 49, 50, 51, 52, 53

P15 — Social Security Modernization

GP=3 · UT=2 · B=4 · Score: 6.0 · Phase III · Bill 9 — UCT Act (healthcare transition reduces SS burden)

GP [3/5 — Partial]

Australia's superannuation system (mandatory employer contributions, government supplements) and Nordic multi-pillar pension systems demonstrate structural reform models; US-specific challenge — preserving earned-benefit covenant while integrating Universal Basic Investment — has limited direct peer analog.

Sources: 62, 288

UT [2/5 — Very Hard]

SSA Trustees Report (2024): OASI depletion by FY2033; combined OASDI: 2034; post-depletion benefits 77% of scheduled; Social Security Fairness Act (2025) worsened trajectory \$195.7B/10yr; 60-vote threshold, AARP political mobilization, and cross-partisan constituent attachment make reform extremely politically constrained; 10+ year implementation.

Sources: 62, 288

B [4/5 — High]

CBO: 75-year actuarial imbalance 4.3% of taxable payroll; solvency requires payroll tax increase from 12.4% to 16.2% or 24% benefit cut absent reform; reorientation toward greatest need would increase replacement rate for lowest-income retirees who currently receive smallest share of pre-retirement income; integration with Universal Basic Investment creates two-pillar retirement system.

Sources: 62, 288

LEGAL & GOVERNANCE

P32 — Repeal / Reform Citizens United

GP=4 · UT=1 · B=5 · Score: 6.7 · Phase III · Bill 11 — DIR Act Phase III Title III

GP [4/5 — Strong]

UK Electoral Commission: strict third-party spending limits; Germany Parteiengesetz: contribution limits and transparency requirements; Canada Elections Act: strict third-party advertising expenditure limits; France: corporate campaign contributions prohibited entirely; US is structural outlier after Citizens United + McCutcheon.

Sources: 197

UT [1/5 — Extremely Hard]

Citizens United is a First Amendment constitutional decision; overturning via legislation requires Supreme Court reversal or constitutional amendment (two-thirds of Congress + 38 states); current Court composition shows no appetite for reconsideration; Track A (enhanced disclosure, foreign corporation prohibitions) is achievable by statute but does not fully address Citizens United holding.

Sources: 196, 197

B [5/5 — Critical]

Corporate campaign expenditure is the primary mechanism by which private economic power translates into legislative outcomes; documented correlation between corporate PAC activity and legislative voting records on taxation, regulation, pharmaceutical pricing; unlimited expenditure concentrates political influence in proportion to wealth, directly inverting democratic equality principle.

Sources: 197

P33 — Supreme Court Reform

GP=3 · UT=2 · B=5 · Score: 6.7 · Phase III · Bill 11 — DIR Act Phase III Title II

GP [3/5 — Partial]

Germany Constitutional Court: single 12-year terms mandatory retirement at 68; Spain Constitutional Court: single 9-year terms; France Constitutional Council: single 9-year terms; no Tier 1 comparator with constitutional review function uses life tenure — US is a structural outlier.

Sources: 197

UT [2/5 — Very Hard]

'Good behaviour' clause (Art. III §1) creates constitutional challenge for statutory term limits; senior status model (active→senior at 18 years) is most constitutionally defensible path and may be achievable by statute; court expansion requires only legislation but faces strong political norm against 'court-packing'; UT=2 because senior status model may be achievable in favorable conditions.

Sources: 196, 197

B [5/5 — Critical]

Post-Dobbs, post-Loper Bright Court has demonstrated that life-tenure justices appointed by minority-popular-vote presidents can eliminate 50-year constitutional rights and reshape the administrative state; term limits align judicial tenure with democratic accountability; Court composition determines constitutional space for every other ARA proposal.

Sources: 196, 197

EDUCATION

P37 — Adopt Scandinavian Education Model

GP=5 · UT=2 · B=5 · Score: 8.0 · Phase III · Executive — DOE rulemaking + state incentives (Phase III)

GP [5/5 — Proven]

Finland: consistent top-tier PISA performance with near-zero achievement gap; US ranks 28th reading, 35th mathematics among OECD; McKinsey (2009): closing US achievement gap would add 3-5% GDP annually; all Nordic nations document superior outcomes relative to US per-student spending.

Sources: 135, 136, 137

UT [2/5 — Very Hard]

K-12 is constitutionally state function; federal lever (Title I, IDEA, ESSA) is incentive-based and constitutionally constrained post-NFIB v. Sebelius; teacher professionalization to Scandinavian level (graduate-degree entry, high salary, high social status) requires 15-20 year pipeline; 300,000 unfilled teaching positions nationally is starting-point deficit; 50-state adoption required.

Sources: 135, 136

B [5/5 — Critical]

Educational outcomes are highest-leverage determinants of lifetime welfare: Chetty et al. Opportunity Insights documents causal relationship between teacher quality and lifetime earnings; Goldin-Katz documents education as primary driver of productivity growth; Finland's documented success closing achievement gaps across income levels is the welfare case — replication at US scale would be generational.

Sources: 135, 136, 137

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

P45 — National High-Speed Rail Network

GP=5 · UT=2 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase III · Executive — Phase III major authorization

GP [5/5 — Proven]

Japan Shinkansen (3,000+ km since 1964), France TGV (2,800+ km since 1981), Germany ICE, China HSR (45,000+ km), Spain AVE, South Korea KTX — all demonstrate HSR viability at national scale with Tier A ridership, energy efficiency, and corridor revenue data; IEA: HSR substantially more energy-efficient per passenger-km than aviation.

Sources: 26, 274

UT [2/5 — Very Hard]

California HSR: 3-4× cost escalation (CHSRA 2025: \$126B from \$33B in 2008); FRA withdrew \$4B grant (2025); right-of-way acquisition costs 3-5× European equivalents in US litigated property system; no dedicated HSR

corridor outside Northeast; interstate commerce framework requires federal authorization; aviation and auto industries benefit from passenger rail underdevelopment.

Sources: 26, 274

B [4/5 — High]

Mode shift from aviation on 200–500 mile corridors with documented cost advantages; HSR rights-of-way provide infrastructure corridors for new power grid and internet infrastructure; reduced highway congestion costs; access to intercity transportation for populations currently served only by private automobile; primary early beneficiaries are higher-income travelers (limits B=5).

Sources: 26, 274

REF_RDNC_ScoringJustification_2026_SectionC — Framework v26 · Scoring Methodology v1.1 · Source Reference Guide v11 · Internal Reference — Not for Distribution · Reform Democrats of the New Commonwealth · Project ARA 2028 · May 2026. All scores carry an estimated +/-1 margin of subjectivity. Developed with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic). The ideas belong to anyone willing to fight for them.